



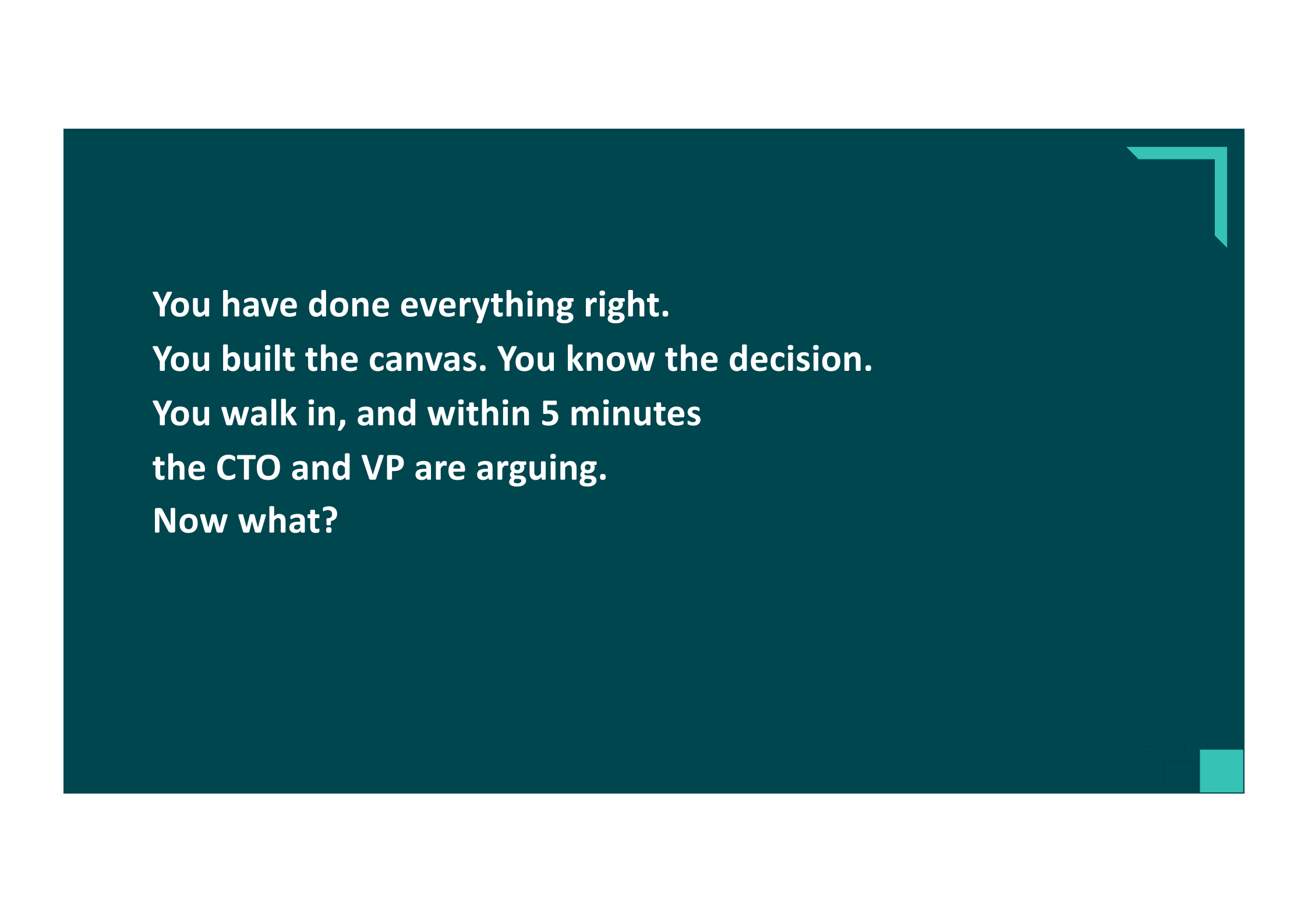
Facilitating in the Room



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**You have done everything right.
You built the canvas. You know the decision.
You walk in, and within 5 minutes
the CTO and VP are arguing.
Now what?**

The First Five Minutes

These five minutes determine whether you facilitate or firefight

1

State the Decision

Say it out loud. Nods mean alignment. Pushback means you found a misalignment early.

2

Verbal Buy-In

Get the room to agree to the process. Harder to derail a process you agreed to.

3

The Parking Lot

A whiteboard box for important-but-off-topic items. Acknowledged, visible, contained.



Become a Solutions Architect

Managing Competing Opinions



Three techniques for when people disagree

Technique

How It Works

Make It Visible



Write both positions on the whiteboard. People face the board instead of each other.

The Criteria Test



Agree on what matters before arguing about solutions. Most disagreements are about unstated priorities.

The Split



Ask "Where do you agree?" Most disagreements are narrower than they feel. Find the 80%.



Become a Solutions Architect

Energy, T-Shape & Commitment



Alternate diverge and converge. Go broad, then deep. End with names and dates.

 Diverge charges

 Converge drains

 T: Broad first

 T: Then deep

Derailers & Executive Drop-Ins

- 1** The Tangent Champion
Validate before redirecting to the parking lot. Skip the validation, they push harder.
- 2** The Silent Dissenter
Give them a safe, expertise-based entry point. "Ravi, what patterns concern you here?"
- 3** The Problem Collector + Exec Drop-In
Channel risk into a scoring structure. For late arrivals: 30-second recap that moves forward.



Commit (names + dates)



Become a Solutions Architect

Commitment Gradient:

"Does anyone object?" = weak

"Who owns this, by when?" = strong

Write names and dates in front of everyone.



Pre-game with AI: Role-play difficult stakeholders before the meeting.

Next Week

Visual Facilitation &
Real-Time Architecture

Whiteboarding with the customer, not for them





Become a Solution Architect

Enhance your Technical and Behavioural Skills